

केन्द्रीय विद्यालय संगठन, बेंगलुरु संभाग
KENDRIYA VIDYALAYA SANGATHAN, BENGALURU REGION
प्री बोर्ड परीक्षा 2025-26
PRE-BOARD-EXAMINATION 2025-26

ENGLISH COMMUNICATIVE -101-MARKING SCHEME

General Instructions: - 1. The Marking Scheme carries only suggested value points for the answers. These are in the nature of Guidelines only and do not constitute the complete answer. The students can have their own expression and if the expression is correct, then due marks should be awarded accordingly.

2. If a student has attempted an extra question, answer of the question deserving more marks should be retained and the other answer scored out with a note “Extra Question”.

3. If more than one option is mentioned in the answer of multiple choice questions, then no marks to be awarded.

	SECTION A (READING SKILLS)	22M
Q1.	Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.	12m
i	Glass production cannot be considered local because most raw materials such as silica sand, soda ash, and limestone are sourced from distant locations. Even historically, places like Venice depended on imports from other regions.	2m
ii	Low-iron glass has become popular in modern architecture because it offers extreme clarity and colourlessness, creating a seamless, minimalist aesthetic. Its transparency, famously used in Apple stores and luxury towers, makes buildings appear open, bright, and high-end.	2m
iii	(B) Minimalist, seamless, and transparent aesthetics are highly valued	1m
iv	(C) Strategic trade, secrecy, and skill, not resources, built Venice’s glass reputation.	1m
v	Architectural glass has a hidden environmental cost because its production is energy-intensive, requires non-renewable resources, and emits carbon dioxide. Transporting raw materials and glass panels increases emissions, while recycling rates remain extremely low, adding to sustainability issues.	2m
vi	From this passage, we can infer that modern architectural choices often prioritise aesthetic appearance over environmental sustainability .	1m
vii	False. Architectural glass is not infinitely recycled into new architectural glass. Only about 6% is downcycled into lower-purity products, and most ends up in landfills	1m
viii	(B) To understand that even ‘transparent’ materials have hidden costs.	1m
ix	(B) Purest.	1m
Q2.	Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.	10m
i	Ananya – because she reads fiction and writes stories, winning 1st prize in an inter-school short story contest.	1m
ii	(A) Actor / Theatre Artist – her interest in poetry and drama, plus experience in theatre, align with performing arts.	1m
iii	Debating and Current Affairs – reading newspapers and magazines strengthens his knowledge and public speaking skills.	1m
iv	(a) She scored 92 in English and won 1st prize in an inter-school short story	2m

	contest. (b) He reads non-fiction (science journals, biographies) and represented the school in a national science quiz.	
v	Drama / Performance – a pen is a tool for writing just as a stage is a platform for performance.	1m
vi	more confident and skilled – he was awarded Best Speaker in an inter-school debate.	1m
vii	Situation (B) – She collaborated with her classmates to ensure everyone played their role in the drama – shows that she is creative but also values teamwork, helping the whole group succeeds.	2m
viii	(A) She writes short stories and won first prize in an inter-school contest	1m
	SECTION B- WRITING SKILLS	22M
3.	Format – 1 Content -1 Accuracy -1 Suggested Content points: The subject I have chosen is not offered in my present section but is available in XI-B. The change will help me pursue my future academic goals and career plans more effectively. Being in XI-B will also allow me to learn under teachers who specialize in the subject I wish to study in greater depth. (accept other valid points too)	3m
4.	Content - 2 Organisation - 1 Accuracy -1 Points you can check: • Brand & model • Display size & design • Processor & storage • Battery life • Features (keyboard, connectivity) • Suitability for studies/work	4m
5.a	LETTER TO THE EDITOR Format -1 Content -3 Organisation -2 Accuracy -1 1. Reduced Social Interaction – People spend more time with gadgets than with family and friends, weakening real-life relationships. 2. Impact on Health – Excessive screen time causes eye strain, obesity, sleep disorders, and stress. 3. Loss of Creativity & Outdoor Activity – Children prefer video games to outdoor play, reducing physical fitness and creative growth. 4. Addiction & Dependence – Overuse of mobiles, social media, and gaming creates unhealthy dependence and distracts from studies/work. 5. Need for Balance – Technology is useful, but it must be balanced with personal connections, hobbies, and healthy lifestyles.	7m
5.b	Format -1 Content -3 Organisation -2 Accuracy -1 The following steps may be considered: 1. Strict enforcement of the Right to Education Act. 2. Awareness campaigns in rural and urban slum areas. 3. Free distribution of books, uniforms, and meals. 4. Incentives for families to send children to school. 5. Active participation of NGOs and local communities.	

6.a	ARTICLE WRITING Format - 1 Content - 3 Organisation – 3 Accuracy -1 Format –Heading, Byline •Boost to Economy – Tourism generates revenue and foreign exchange. • Employment Opportunities – It creates jobs in hotels, transport, and handicrafts. • Preservation of Heritage – Promotes protection of monuments and culture. • Cultural Exchange – Builds global understanding and harmony. • Infrastructure Growth – Better roads, airports, and facilities benefit citizens • Environmental Awareness – Eco-tourism encourages conservation. • Educational Value – Travel enriches knowledge and broadens outlook. (Give credit to all relevant points)	8m																				
6.b	The rapid growth of technology has given rise to a new environmental hazard—electronic waste. Discarded gadgets like mobiles, computers, and televisions often end up in landfills, releasing toxic substances such as lead, mercury, and cadmium. These contaminate soil, water, and air, posing serious risks to human health and ecosystems. • Awareness campaigns on safe disposal. •Strict laws to regulate e-waste management. •Recycling and reuse of old gadgets. •Take-back policies by manufacturers. •Use of eco-friendly materials in production. •Government–NGO partnerships for collection drives. •Individual responsibility to reduce gadget obsession and dispose responsibly.																					
	SECTION C (GRAMMAR)	10M																				
7	Complete the following passage by filling in the missing word: - i) from ii) looked iii) the	3m																				
8	Identify the missing word in each line:- <table><tr><td>NO.</td><td>Word before</td><td>Word omitted</td><td>Word after</td></tr><tr><td>i</td><td>man</td><td>was</td><td>getting</td></tr><tr><td>ii</td><td>peep</td><td>in</td><td>the</td></tr><tr><td>iii</td><td>see</td><td>how</td><td>many</td></tr><tr><td>iv</td><td>time</td><td>when</td><td>his</td></tr></table>	NO.	Word before	Word omitted	Word after	i	man	was	getting	ii	peep	in	the	iii	see	how	many	iv	time	when	his	4m
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9	REPORTED SPEECH (i) if he had seen her new umbrella (ii) if she had bought it from the mall (iii) his father had brought it for her.	3m																				
	SECTION D (LITERATURE)	26M																				
10	Read the following extracts given below and attempt ANY TWO :-	4+4																				
a.i	The illness acts as a turning point because it makes the postmaster personally experience the anxiety of waiting, mirroring Ali’s suffering.	1m																				
ii	His empathy is partly genuine but also largely self-centred — he only	1m																				

	understands Ali's grief when he suffers himself.	
iii	The irony is that the postmaster ignored Ali's agony for years but could understand it only when fate put him in the same position.	1m
iv	The word " distressed " can be replaced with <i>the word "anxious"</i>	1m
b.i	Coleridge uses vivid imagery of stillness - "no breath nor motion"—to create the imagery of a motionless ship emphasising helplessness and despair, intensifying the sailors' suffering	1m
ii	The sailors feel trapped and powerless, like prisoners of nature. Their inability to move forward mirrors their despair, exhaustion, and growing hopelessness.	1m
iii	The literary device is a simile - "As idle as a painted ship / Upon a painted ocean."	1m
iv	The poem is " The Rime of the Ancient Mariner " by Samuel Taylor Coleridge .	1m
c.i	She wants Victoria to wear her best dress to impress Mrs. Jordan and her family.	1m
ii	It shows her obsession with appearances and her desire to look superior in front of others.	1m
iii	While she should be grieving her father's death, she is instead busy with furniture, clothes, and appearances. Mrs. Slater is more concerned with outward image than mourning, showing her hypocrisy.	1m
iv	A synonym for 'put on' is ' wear '	1m
11	Answer any five of the following six questions in about 40 words each:-	5x2
i	Jacopo and Nicola show their dedication by risking their lives and enduring hardships to help their sister Lucia who is bed-ridden with tuberculosis of spine. Their loyalty, sacrifice, and concern for the sister reflect deep familial love and commitment.	
ii	The "Writer's Inspiration Bureau" was formed to provide ready-made ideas and suggestions for writers who faced writer's block. It aimed to inspire creativity and help writers overcome their mental blocks.	
iii	Vikram Seth conveys the dangers of blind imitation, flattery, and exploitation. The poem warns against gullibility and dependence on those who may take advantage of one's talent, emphasizing the need for self-confidence and discernment.	
iv	Mrs. Packletide remarked this because, apart from the cost of shooting the tiger and paying the villagers she had to spend a lot on her companion, gifts, and arrangements to maintain her image	
v	Shakespeare conveys that physical monuments and statues decay over time, but poetry immortalizes beauty and love. By writing the sonnet, he ensures that his beloved's beauty will live forever in words, defying the passage of time.	
vi	Patol Babu's mentor advised him to act naturally and use personal experience rather than memorize lines mechanically. By following this advice, Patol Babu delivered a convincing performance, winning the director's appreciation and personal satisfaction.	
12	Answer any one of the following two questions in about 150 words:-	1x8
a	In " <i>The Snake</i> ", the speaker is fascinated by a snake that comes to his water-	

	trough. He admires the creature and sees it as a peaceful guest. However, he also feels pressure from the "voices of his education" that tell him to kill the snake, as it is seen as dangerous. This internal struggle between his natural instincts and learned behavior causes him to act impulsively—he throws a log at the snake as it leaves. Immediately, he feels ashamed and calls the act “mean,” “paltry,” and “vulgar.” This shows how societal fear, and prejudice can override personal judgment and lead to regret. Similarly, in “<i>Julius Caesar</i>”, Brutus is torn between his loyalty to Caesar and his duty to Rome. Influenced by Cassius and the fear that Caesar might become a tyrant, Brutus joins the conspiracy to assassinate him. Although Caesar has not done anything wrong yet, Brutus convinces himself that killing him is necessary to prevent future harm—likening Caesar to a "serpent's egg" that must be destroyed before it hatches. After the murder, Brutus struggles with guilt and inner turmoil, and his decision eventually leads to civil war and his own tragic end.	
b	Both <i>A Shady Plot</i> and <i>Patol Babu, Filmstar</i> explore the tension between material gain and personal satisfaction. John Hallock in <i>A Shady Plot</i> faces moral dilemmas as he prioritizes personal interest over honesty, leading to internal conflict and stress. His struggle shows that chasing wealth or shortcuts can compromise integrity and peace of mind. In contrast, Patol Babu in <i>Patol Babu, Filmstar</i> demonstrates dedication, patience, and love for art. Even though he earns modestly, his commitment to authentic performance brings him personal fulfilment and pride. Despite his age and the small role offered, Patol Babu performs with sincerity and takes pride in his work rather than focusing on money or fame. From these stories, we learn that true success is not measured by money or recognition alone, but by integrity, passion, and satisfaction derived from one’s work. Inner fulfilment arises from honesty, dedication, and doing one’s best, regardless of external rewards.	
